

# **MuniBridge User Guide**

(Work in Progress)

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**If you need further assistance, contact Support at your convenience.**

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# Managing Meters

## Changeouts

1. Select the Account associated with the meter being replaced
2. Double-click the  **WATER** Utility
3. Click **Meter Changeout** on the bottom right
4. Enter the new meter details & old meter final read
5. **Save**

Tip: Hover over the text boxes to see a description of the field.

Note: Changeouts will show 2 highlighted rows in the  **Meter** history tab. It is normal for the top row to have a negative current read. This negative read ensures the customer gets billed for their final read.

## Editing Meter Number

Editing the meter number can be useful if the meter is still physically the same, but you need to make a change, such as removing a leading 0.

1. Select the Account associated with the meter being replaced
2. Double-click the  **WATER** Utility
3. Right-click **Meter Changeout** on the bottom right
4. Select **Bypass Changeout**
5. Edit **Meter #** field
6. **Save**

## Rollovers

When Verifying & Editing water usage after uploading or entering meter reads, it is not uncommon to have a negative actual usage. Example:

| Old Date   | Old Reading | New Reading ▲ | New Date | Actual Usage |
|------------|-------------|---------------|----------|--------------|
| 10/27/2025 | 999,300     | 7,000         | 1/5/2026 | -992,300     |

Rolling over a meter can only be done during the **Verify & Edit** stage.

To do so, right-click the negative-usage row, and select **Rollover**

**Note:** Rollovers will show 2 highlighted rows in the  **Meter** history tab. It is normal for the top row to have a negative current read. This negative read ensures the customer gets billed for their full, rolled-over usage.

The row in the **Verify & Edit table** will update to show this negative current read. In this example, the **Old Reading** will be -700, and **Actual Usage** would become 7,700.

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## Managing Utilities

### Adding Utility to Location

1. Select the Account holder of the location to add a Utility to
2. Right-click the Utilities display in the bottom right corner
3. Select  (Grayed out if 4 Utilities exist. Contact support if needing more)
4. Select Utility from dropdown. Double-check **rate code** and **# of EDUs**
5. **Create**

### Temporarily Turning Off Utility

1. Select the Account associated with the Utility
2. Double-click the Utility
3. Un-check ☐ **Active** checkbox
4. **Save**

### Permanently Removing Utility From Location

1. Select the Account associated with the Utility
2. Double-click the Utility
3. Click **Archive Utility** 

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## Moving Customers In/Out

### Moveout

1. Select the Account to move out of the Service Location
2. Double-click the row
3. Click **Move Out**

The Service Location will become vacant so another account can move in.  
The Service Location keeps all Utilities attached to it.

### Movein

1. Select the Account to move into a Service Location
2. Double-click the row
3. Click **Move In**
4. **Select** the Service Location

It is best practice to **create** a new **Account** anytime you are moving someone into a Service Location.

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## Billing Cycle Steps (Start to Finish)

### 1. Opening a New Bill Cycle

To open a new bill cycle, go to the  **Billing** tab, then click **New Bill Cycle** 

If the existing bill cycle is incomplete, a warning will show missing invoices.

All numbered route boxes in the top left corner will now be gray, indicating they have zero bills.

### 2. Route Sheets (Optional)

If using route sheets for meter reading, click **Route Sheets** 

Selecting **Clear Meter Messages** will remove all meter work orders/requests. These requests can be added in the **Verify & Edit** stage for the meter reader person to see on the route sheets.

### 3. Entering/Uploading Meter Reads

Select one of three options:

1. **Manual Entries**  Enter reads manually, such as from handwritten reads
2. **Upload CSV**  Upload reads from a meter probe via text file
3. **Estimate Route**  Estimate usages. Reads are not affected, which prevents catchups

### 4. Submitting Reads

If **Estimating**, skip this step.

Click **Verify & Edit**  if available. If not, you should see a **Dispose Errors**  button

Preview any errors before clicking **Dispose Errors** 

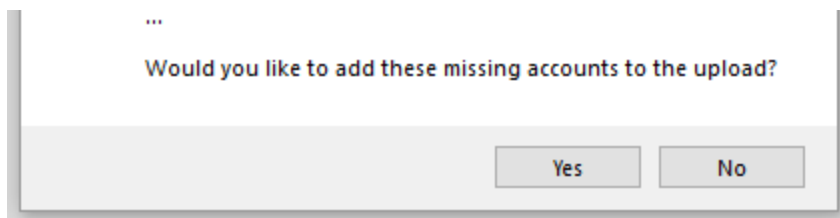
#### **Most Common Errors:**

**ALREADY BILLED-** The customer has already been billed during this bill cycle.

**INVALID READ-** The probe took a bad read, such as '??0000'.

**METER NOT FOUND-** This usually means that the meter is not set up properly for that Service Location. Try searching for the meter number using the last 5 digits to see if it exists. (Leading 0 can often be the problem) See [Editing Meter Number](#), or [Changeouts](#) if the meter was replaced recently.

You will most likely get a pop-up like:



In most cases, you will want to click **Yes** so you can estimate or manually enter missed reads later.

## 5. Reviewing Calculated Usages (Verify & Edit)

When working in the **Verify & Edit** table, you will see **many** colors that each have their own meaning.

Click  **Legend** in the top right corner to see what each color means.

### Quick Tips:

**The most important columns are furthest right (Actual Usage, Bill Usage, Avg., and Flag)**

Right-click a row to see additional options.

**Bill Usage** is the most important column of all— It purely drives the water usage bill. After estimating bills, bill usage will often be much lower (in rare cases, higher) than the actual usage.

**Actual Usage** is the last meter read subtracted from the newest meter read. This number will be the same as bill usage, *unless* the last read was estimated.

**Avg.** is the expected usage based on prior reads and season.

**Flag** indicates the type of read:

**ESTIMATE**- Cannot modify reads or actual usage. Only **bill usage** can be changed.

**PHYSICAL**- Can make changes, but not recommended unless typos are present.

**WTR OFF**- Water is turned off. Customer will be billed only for other utilities **if** active.

**UNREAD**- Needs estimated, reading entered, or removed for now (can be billed later).

Change flag by right-clicking the row, then select **Mark as Estimate** or **Enter Physical Read**

**If making changes, see [Verify & Edit Detailed](#).**

Handle all errors before proceeding.

## 6. Previewing Bills

Click **Calculate Bills**  once all errors are handled.

Click [View Pending Charges / Penalties](#) to see what charges will be added to the bills

Click **Calculate** to continue to the preview

The most import columns **Prev Balance and Charge** are on the right.

Prev balance will be red if there is a **penalty**.

Penalties can be removed by right-clicking the row and selecting  **Remove Penalty**

Charge will be **highlighted** if lower or higher than certain amounts specified in **Settings>Preferences>Table Appearance>Highlight Bill**

Name will be **highlighted** if bill contains misc charge/pending charge.

## 7. Posting Bills

Select batch message from the dropdown if desired.

To create a new one, select [< Add New >](#) from the dropdown. Type message. Do not forget to save 

Sort the table if you would like the bills printed in a particular order. This is displayed beside the **Next** button:

Sorted by: Rte., Read Seq.

Next

Cancel

Click **Next** to continue to the **Print & Post** window.

Select desired options under **Printing**

Tip:

Hover over Group Billing & Credit Balance options for explanations on what they do.

Click **Preview**  to preview paper bills.

Change settings in the top left corner if needed before printing.

Click **Post All** to post the invoices to the MuniBridge database and QuickBooks.

## 8. Finishing Up (Last Steps After ALL Bills Are Posted)

Click **View Bill Cycle**  to see if any customers are missing a bill.

Click **Bill Closed Accounts** in the top menu to bill accounts that have moved out with an outstanding balance.

Click **Print Group Bills**  if available (hidden if there are no group bills to print)  
This step is done after ALL bills are complete.

Click **View Bill List**  for a report of the charges posted to each account.

Contact **Support** if anything looks abnormal at any point in this process.

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## Verify & Edit Detailed

### Bill Usage vs. Actual Usage

Bill usage and actual usage are tracked separately to prevent meter catchups after estimating reads.

Actual usage reflects the usage since the last physical read— meaning it will appear larger than normal after estimating usage.

To ensure an accurate bill to the customer, we calculate bill usage. We subtract the usage that was already billed to the customer during the estimated months.

Click [here](#) to see more.

### Overwriting an Estimate with a Physical Read

If you have an estimated read that you need to switch to a physical read, right-click the row and select **Enter Physical Read**.

### Adding a Read

Currently, adding extra reads to the open table is limited. There are plans to make this more efficient in the future.

1. Click **Add More**  in the bottom right corner
2. Select **Route** from dropdown that customer resides in
3. Select **Acct No.** (or **Serv. ID**) from dropdown. These are in order based off of read sequence
4. Enter **Reading**
5. Click **Add Entry**
6. Repeat for additional rows to add

### Estimating an Unread Reading

Unread readings are highlighted in gray. You can estimate them by double-clicking **ESTIMATE**, or clicking **Estimate All Missing**  in the bottom right of the screen. Estimates can later be switched to physical.

### Negative Usage

When the new read is less than the old read, it usually indicates one of the following:

- Rollover (if prior read was high, such as 997,200). See [Rollovers](#).
- One of the reads was entered in manually incorrectly, or the read was guessed
- Meter issue

Do **NOT** change the new reading to be greater than the old reading— this only prolongs the issue. If necessary, you can change the old reading to match the new reading, so the usage is 0. To do so, click **Advanced** and select **Enable All Prior Read Edits**. You can now edit the old reads.



To prevent negative reads, it is important that reads are never guessed. If you do not have a read, estimate. This prevents negative usage/meter catchups. See [Estimating an Unread Reading](#).

**“TYPE” Estimate in Bill Usage**

When the software cannot create a valid estimate for a meter, it replaces the Bill Usage with “TYPE”, indicating that you must type in Bill Usage manually. If you’re unsure what type, 0 or your minimum bill usage is a safe estimate. Example:

|         |         |           |   |      |     |          |
|---------|---------|-----------|---|------|-----|----------|
| 570,600 | 570,599 | 4/28/2026 | 0 | TYPE | ??? | ESTIMATE |
|---------|---------|-----------|---|------|-----|----------|

**Saving Progress for Shutdown**

If necessary to close the MuniBridge software while making changes to the **Verify & Edit** table, you can save the table by clicking **File** in the top left, then select **Export**.

To continue where you left off from a save file, select **Import**.

These tables are automatically saved as well each time you calculate bills, in case you run into any issues and need support to restore your work or troubleshoot issues.

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**Adjustments & Deletes**

**Adjusting Invoice After Posting**

TODO

Contact support for assistance.

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**What to Avoid**

**Reusing Accounts (Avoid)**

Anytime a property changes hands, regardless of whether the same customer is moving from one property to another, it is best practice to create a **new** account with a **new** account number.

This prevents later issues related to history or audit trails.

To encourage this practice, a convenient method to copy customer info to a new account has been implemented. Use the [Copy to New](#)  feature, which can be found by right-clicking an account in the  [Accounts](#) tab.

**Deleting Service Locations (Avoid)**

Service Location behavior is the exact **opposite** of accounts.

When a property changes hands, you **Move Out** the customer (found by double-clicking an account). This makes the Service Locations vacant so it can be assigned to another account using **Move In** button.

The meter number, utilities, and service address stay tied to the location, and does not need to be re-created for the account moving in.

## **Making Adjustments in QuickBooks (Avoid)**

One part that can be confusing about MuniBridge is that you enter payments through QuickBooks, but you should **not** be creating or adjusting invoices using QuickBooks.

Creating or adjusting invoices should be handled via MuniBridge to keep everything in sync.

See [Adjustments & Deletes](#)

## **Creating/Editing Customers in QuickBooks (Avoid)**

MuniBridge handles all Customer creation and changes to keep info in sync. You should **not** be making Customer changes using QuickBooks.

Creating or editing customers should be handled via MuniBridge to keep everything in sync.

## **Guessing or Modifying Reads to Prevent Negative (Avoid)**

Changing reads to create a positive usage leads to more issues down the road. See [Negative Usage](#).

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# **Support**

## **Remote Help**

To get remote help, you will need a Gmail account— personal or business.

Steps:

1. Get in touch to schedule time for support
2. Call
3. Click **Help** inside of MuniBridge in the top right, then select **Remote Support**
4. Click **Share My Screen**
5. Click **Generate Code**
6. Share the code

## **Contact**

**Call / Text:** Riley Paris  
814-439-5490  
**Email:** [riley@munibridge-solutions.com](mailto:riley@munibridge-solutions.com)

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